



National Executive Board

LAMBDA SIGMA UPSILON LATINO FRATERNITY, INC.

Mental Health Support Policy

Purpose

The purpose of this policy is to ensure that members of Lambda Sigma Upsilon Latino Fraternity, Inc. are supported in their mental health and well-being. The fraternity is committed to creating a safe, inclusive, and supportive environment that promotes mental wellness, reduces stigma, and provides resources for those in need.

Scope

This policy applies to all active undergraduate and alumni members of Lambda Sigma Upsilon Latino Fraternity, Inc. across all chapters.

Key Principles

1. **Confidentiality:** All mental health-related concerns shared with fraternity leadership will be treated with the utmost confidentiality, except in cases where the individual is at risk of harming themselves or others.
2. **Non-Discrimination:** No member shall face discrimination, exclusion, or judgment based on their mental health status. The fraternity encourages open dialogue and support without stigma.
3. **Proactive Mental Health Awareness:** The fraternity will actively promote mental health awareness through workshops, resources, and programs aimed at educating members on mental wellness and stress management.

Mental Health Resources

1. **Access to Professional Support:** The fraternity will establish partnerships with mental health organizations, counseling services, and online platforms (e.g., Better Help, talk space) to provide members with access to affordable or discounted professional counseling services.
2. **Mental Health Workshops and Training:** Each academic year, the fraternity will organize workshops on mental health topics such as:
 - a. Stress management
 - b. Coping with anxiety and depression
 - c. Self-care strategies
 - d. Identifying signs of mental health crises in others and oneself

3. Peer Support Network: The fraternity will foster a peer support network where trained brothers can serve as mental health ambassadors. These ambassadors will:
 - a. Be trained in Mental Health First Aid or similar programs
 - b. Act as a first point of contact for brothers in distress
 - c. Guide brothers toward professional help and support as needed
4. Emergency Resources: Information on 24/7 mental health hotlines (e.g., National Suicide Prevention Lifeline, Crisis Text Line) will be shared with all members. In times of crisis, brothers will be encouraged to seek immediate help through these channels.

Mental Health Days and Supportive Environment

1. Mental Health Days: Members will be encouraged to take "mental health days" when needed. The fraternity will respect and support the use of these days for self-care, recognizing the importance of time off to recharge mentally and emotionally.
2. Creating Safe Spaces: Chapter meetings and events will foster an environment where members feel comfortable discussing mental health openly. This includes providing time and space to talk about stress, academic pressures, and personal challenges.
3. Inclusivity: Fraternity events and activities will include options that prioritize members' mental well-being, ensuring that participation does not contribute to undue stress or pressure. For example, flexibility around deadlines for fraternity responsibilities will be offered to members experiencing mental health challenges.

Crisis Response Protocol

If a brother is experiencing a mental health crisis:

1. Immediate Assistance: Brothers are encouraged to immediately seek professional help if they or another member is in crisis. This includes calling 911 in emergencies or utilizing crisis hotlines.
2. Support from the Fraternity: The fraternity's mental health ambassadors and leadership will offer support by guiding the individual toward professional resources and ensuring their safety.
3. Follow-Up: After a crisis, chapter leaders or designated mental health ambassadors will follow up with the member to check on their well-being and offer ongoing support, if needed.

Mental Health Advocacy

Lambda Sigma Upsilon Latino Fraternity, Inc. will advocate for mental health awareness both within the fraternity and in the broader community by:

1. Partnering with local and national mental health organizations to raise awareness.
2. Participating in or organizing community events, such as walks, workshops, or fundraising initiatives for mental health causes.
3. Encouraging brothers to take part in mental health advocacy efforts in their local communities.

Accountability and Continuous Improvement

1. Annual Review: This policy will be reviewed annually to ensure it remains relevant, effective, and up to date with best practices in mental health support.
2. Feedback from Members: Members will be invited to provide feedback on the mental health programs and resources offered, ensuring that the fraternity is responsive to the evolving needs of its members.

Conclusion

Lambda Sigma Upsilon Latino Fraternity, Inc. is committed to fostering an environment that supports the mental health and well-being of all members. By providing access to resources, education, and a supportive community, the fraternity aims to reduce stigma, promote wellness, and ensure that every member feels empowered to seek help when needed. This policy not only supports the mental well-being of fraternity members but also aligns with the fraternity's commitment to brotherhood, service, and community engagement.

Last Updated: September 2024